National Tertiary Education Union
Let's aim higher

UTAS COUNCIL ACADEMIC NOMINEE



Dr Rob Clarke

I am excited to nominate as the Academic Staff Representative for the UTAS Council. I will bring integrity, experience, and energy to this role at a critical juncture in our University's future.

I have worked in universities for 25 years and have gained extensive leadership and governance experience while staying connected to my teaching and research community: a combination that will equip me well for this position.

I am an English Studies lecturer and researcher. I've been employed at UTas since 2008, and before that I taught at Chuo University, Japan, and the University of Queensland. While at UTAS, I have served as an innovative and empathic Head of Discipline for the English and Writing Program for over 6 years, a collegial member of multiple School leadership teams, and a judicious representative of my College on Academic Senate (2024/2025). To these roles, I have brought informed judgment, clear strategic thinking, and a commitment to genuine consultation to advocate for the needs and priorities of academic staff.

In every role I undertake, I am guided by two core principles: that universities are immeasurably valuable public goods; and that the work of academics and professional staff are the central pillars that support university life.

In recent years, I have effectively advocated for improved safety at the University, and I currently serve as an accredited Health and Safety Representative in the School of Humanities and Social Sciences. I have worked closely with staff, managers, and senior leaders to improve consultation processes, address workplace concerns, and support positive outcomes. Much remains to be done to improve safety at UTAS, particularly psychosocial safety for staff and students, and I will make this a priority during my tenure on Council.

As an active member of the National Tertiary Education Union, I am committed to consultative and collective action to improve working conditions for all staff and ensure we can all fulfil our roles as teachers, researchers, and administrators. I believe fervently in academic freedom and in cultivating genuine engagement between University programs and our communities and cultural institutions.

I understand that the Council's responsibility is to ensure the University's sustainability, safeguard academic quality, manage risk, and advance its mission and values. Yet, I also understand that the Council cannot perform its roles properly without attending to the priorities and collective experience and wisdom of its academic staff. And I look forward to serving that role.